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AFRICAN VISION MALAWI

CREATING LASTING CHANGE

Issue 34

Newsletter
Winter 2022

Charity no
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Our Vision: A healthy, educated, self-sufficient community in Malawi

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Many congratulations to Marie Brown



who was made CEO on July 1st. We wish her all success in her new role. Marie has been in Malawi for 6 years and worked both within Health and Education sectors. We look forward to working with her in this new role.

Heather Palmer has stepped down and moved into Founder & Trustee role and will still be very much involved in the programmes and direction of the charity.

SUSTAINABLE AGRICULTURE







We have been working with a community in Chitsime centre with the support of our partners SCOPE Malawi. Their Seed & Knowledge Initiative (SKI) has been encouraging people to focus on indigenous seeds and organic ways of growing, such as making organic compost, rather than relying on fertilisers. One of the key elements is to encourage local seed multiplication, both for sustainability and for sale or barter. 84 farmers have taken part and many were asked to display their seeds at SustainFest 2022 (photos above), held in Lilongwe on 7th October. It was amazing to see so many different seeds.

We have been working on the SKI programme for the past 4 years. We started with mapping the village to find baseline details. In October we did it again to find the impact analysis. The amazing result of this programme is that 50 out of the 84 farmers say they are now totally self-sufficient; an incredible result! They no longer buy fertiliser or seeds and are able to have food all year round. We now want to spread this programme further out into our communities.

Kondwani Galanga (bottom right) is our Permaculture Officer and has run two **Household Permaculture** training sessions, allowing 40 local marginalised people being trained in setting up a small garden, close to their house. This will provide them with food all year round, resulting in self-sufficiency. In Malawi Jan-March are classified as the 'hungry months' as subsistent farmers rely on growing one crop a year; by this time their food is running out. People normally harvest in May. Many of the gardens are successful, particularly those owned by women; the focus on future training will be empowering women farmers.









SAM'S VILLAGE




It was wonderful to have our official opening of Sam's Village on September 29th. We were delighted that Noel Hayes (our main benefactor) could join us on the day. Besides the speeches and a drama by the existing vocational trainees, we had 'stations ' dotted around the site giving people the opportunity to see our outreach programmes, walk around the buildings and chat to the trainees.




We have been training 25 marginalised youths in tailoring and carpentry. Both much needed skills in the community. All passed their course and will receive accredited certificates. The graduation will be on December 15th. This training will empower them to become self-sufficient. We have managed to feed the trainees with vegetables from our gardens and greenhouse, which is looking well stocked!

(photos left to right) Duncan Chiyani, George Phiri and Eric Munthali; Trainees drama; Noel Hayes, Rev. Elias Mwaza, Heather & Nigel Palmer; Health programme station





(photos left to right) Greenhouse; Carpentry trainee; Tailoring trainee

STAFF & VOLUNTEERS





Marie Brown (CEO) *(above left)* married Justin Ngulube in December and we wish them much happiness together.



Thanks to Carol Webb *(above centre)* who came out to Malawi in October to support our first Partnership link visit after a 2-year Covid break. Here she is preparing the packs.

Peter Happy (gardener) *(above right)* had twins in April and is here transporting his wife and children on a motorbike (health & safety not quite the same in Malawi!) Congratulations to them both!

Wezzie Gwaluka (Education Manager) *(right photo)* got married to Yamikani Chilonga in October. Many congratulation to both of them!

EDUCATION





Scholarship programme

Over three weeks in October, Carol Webb facilitated our School Partnership visits. It is no mean feat with 24 UK partnerships linked with 22 Malawi primary schools (1 pre-school). It was great to be back after a 2 year break. The theme was 'Celebrations' and students were interested in what and how we celebrate. Packs have now returned to the UK and we are doing assemblies in our partnership schools here. The next theme will be 'Weather and climate change' with a visit in October 2023.

Early Childhood Development (ECD)




We are very grateful to Katey's House Nursery school who are partnered with M'teza pre-school. They also produced a lovely pack on 'celebrations'. They have raised funds to build better toilets at M'teza; work will start soon. Wezzie is helping put a teddy on one of the children's backs in the photo (left). Mothers carry their babies this way!

Our grateful thanks also go to Gandy's Foundation who have donated funds for us to keep the children at Funsani pre-school fed with porridge each morning. They are also providing a Christmas lunch and gift for the children in December.



Scholarship programme We currently have 81 students in secondary and university. Most of which have sponsors but we have a shortfall in funds and if you would like to make a specific difference to an orphan, please set up a monthly donation for 'education'. Thank you! And grateful thanks to all our sponsors!

(photos top) Bowa and Songwe school partnership visits with Carol Webb and Wezzie Gwaluka. (photo left) Wezzie at M'teza CBCC and Funsani feeding programme (photo right) James Kaphukira graduation

HEALTH



Emma Katengeza manages our Health programmes which impact our community positively as health access isn't widely available. Our 10 Medical outreach programmes access up to 3,000 sick people each month. This programme is funded by Love Support Unite. The Dental programme in November focused on 5 primary schools and targeted the younger children. Approximately 1,000 children were screened and given immediate treatment of fillings and extractions. All were provided with toothbrushes and toothpaste and educated on teeth hygiene.



We have a Disability programme and Vulnerable people programme. If you would like to support anyone on our database, you can make a difference to their lives. For example Ismael (right) is 11 years old and needs a wheelchair as his mother is now unable to carry him on her back! £200 can make a world of difference!



We have a partnership with 500 Miles who provide prosthetic limbs and orthotic devices for people with disability. We are very excited that Beth Sheehan (AVM Trustee) has returned to Malawi to retake up the post of Manager there. We look forward to working further in partnership to change people's lives and make them independent.

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THANKS TO:
INQ.DIGITAL MALAWI
LOVE SUPPORT UNITE
OUR CYCLISTS
SARAH PARSLOE
HOLY GHOST PRIMARY
THE MALL PREP SCHOOL
ST JOHNS PRIMARY
ST PAULS CE PRIMARY
KATEY'S HOUSE NURSERY
OUR MALAWI TEAM
500 MILES
ALL SAINTS KNITTERS
TRUSTEES
IRISH EMBASSY
GANDYS FOUNDATION
ST MATTHEW'S CHURCH
EILEEN SPEAK
GAYNOR COOK
PARTNERSHIP SCHOOLS
HEATHER CUMMINS
JANE THOMPSON
ST MARY'S CHURCH

2022 'Pedal Power' Cycle Challenge







We are so grateful to the 6 cyclists who took part in the 2022 cycle challenge in Malawi. The 500km was even more of a challenge with temperatures heading up to the mid 30's but the experience as always was positive. After the ride they had a two-day experience of seeing the impact of our programmes and some stayed for a rest at the lake afterwards. If you want to join us on the next cycle in May 2023, please see the link below.

Photos— (top left) cycle group with children, (top right) cycling along some of the roads (bottom left) visiting one of our vocational training graduates doing carpentry.

FUNDRAISING EVENTS

Pedal Power 2023 — Depart UK **Friday 12th May** and fly back after 23rd May. Exciting optional extra is to go to the famous music festival 'Lake of Stars' from 26th-28th May held on the lake shore. An experience of a lifetime. £2,100 (includes local transport, accommodation, food, guide, bike hire, safari, visit cave paintings and backup support). We shall do a talk on January 21st from 10am if you are interested to know more. Please get in touch here.



Art exhibition—'Woman is airborne' by artist Cilla Taylor. 14th Jan—26th Feb. Open evening on **Tuesday 17th January** from 7pm. Theme is allowing women to 'fly'; giving opportunities to voice themselves. Artwork, poetry and 3D mobiles for sale and all proceeds go to reforestation in Malawi. The cornerHOUSE arts centre, 116 Douglas Road, KT6 7SB

https://www.africanvision.org.uk/events/art-exhibition-at-the-cornerhouse/

Recent events:

Pedal Power 2022 — See above. We are grateful to all the cyclists who came and so far raised an incredible £25,000! We are blown away!

Indulgence Day—June 18th—we had an beautiful day in the garden with therapists, musicians and stall holders. We made an amazing £2,689 on the day. Thanks to all the volunteers and therapists who contributed to the day.

We are very grateful for our School Partnership links. We have 24 links in UK with 22 schools in Malawi (1 pre-school). Over the past 6 months we have had donations from the following schools to support their link school. Thanks for making a difference!

St Pauls CE Primary partnered with Bowa Primary School raised £417.51

Holy Ghost Primary partnered with Masiye Primary raised £100

Katey's House Nursery partnered with M'teza CBCC raised £234.78

The Mall Prep school linked with Chitsime Primary raised £270.50

St Johns C of E Primary linked with M'khalapadzuwa raised £326.50